08-16

Air Force to conduct an internal investigation. The result was summarized in two reports. The first, released in 1995, concluded that the reported recovered material in 1947 was likely debris from a secret government program called Project Mogul, which involved high-altitude balloons

08-17

meant to detect sound waves generated by Soviet atomic bomb tests and ballistic missiles. The second report, released two years later, in 1997, concluded that reports of recovered alien bodies were likely a combination of: innocently transformed memories of military

08-18

accidents involving injured or killed personnel; innocently transformed memories of the recovery of anthropomorphic dummies in military programs US conducted in the 1950s; and hoaxes that various witnesses and UFO proponents perpetrated. The psychological effects of time compression and confusion about when

08-19

events occurred explained the discrepancy with the years in question. In January 1997, Karl Pflock, one of the more prominent pro-UFO researchers, said: "Based on my research and that of others, I'm as certain as it's possible to be without absolute proof that no flying saucer or saucers crashed in

08-20

the general vicinity of Roswell or on the Plains of San Agustin in 1947.[He then added: "The debris found was the remains of something very earthly, all but certainly something from the Top Secret Project Mogul." Although most now agree with this conclusion, each year, during July Fourth weekend, the

08-21

City of Roswell hosts the Roswell UFO Festival celebrating all things UFO, featuring prominent UFOlogists and discussions.

09-01

Tulip mania was a period in the Dutch Golden Age during which contract prices for bulbs of the recently introduced tulip reached extraordinarily high levels and then suddenly collapsed. At the peak of tulip mania in February 1637, tulip contracts sold for more than ten times the annual income of a

09-02

skilled craftsman. It is generally considered the first recorded economic bubble. The tulip, introduced to Europe in the mid-sixteenth century from the Ottoman Empire, became very popular in the United Provinces, which we now know as the Netherlands. Tulip cultivation in the United Provinces is

09-03

generally thought to have started in earnest around 1593 after the Flemish botanist Charles de l'~stecluse had taken up a post at the University of Leiden and established a botanical garden, which is famous as one of the oldest in the world. There, he planted his collection of tulip bulbs that the Emperor's ambassador

09-04

sent to him from Turkey, which were able to tolerate the harsher conditions of the northern climate. It was shortly thereafter that the tulips began to grow in popularity. The flower rapidly became a coveted luxury item and a status symbol, and a profusion of varieties followed. They were classified in groups:

08-06

even by UFO researchers, for more than thirty years. Then, in 1978, nuclear physicist and author Stanton Friedman interviewed Jesse Marcel, the only person known to have accompanied the Roswell debris from where it was recovered to Fort Worth. Over the next few years, the accounts he and others gave

08-07

elevated Roswell from a forgotten incident to perhaps the most famous UFO case of all time. By the early 1990s, UFO researchers had interviewed several hundred people who had, or who claimed to have had, a connection with the events at Roswell in 1947. Additionally, hundreds of

08-08

documents were obtained by Freedom of Information Act requests, as were some that insiders apparently leaked. Their conclusions were that at least one alien craft had crashed in the Roswell vicinity, that aliens, some possibly still alive, were recovered, and that a massive cover-up of any knowledge of the incident was put in

08-09

place. Numerous books, articles, television specials, and even a made-for-TV movie brought the 1947 incident fame and notoriety so that by the mid-1990s, strong majorities in polls, such as a 1997 CNN/Time poll, believed that aliens had visited

08-10

earth and specifically that aliens had landed at Roswell and the government was covering up the fact. During the 1980s and 1990s, a new narrative emerged which was at strong odds with what was reported in 1947. This narrative evolved over the years from the time the first book on Roswell was published in

08-11

1980 as many new witnesses and accounts emerged, drawn out in part by the publicity on the incident. Of the hundreds of witnesses that the various researchers interviewed - a seemingly impressive figure - a comparable few were true "witnesses" who claimed to have actually seen debris or

08-12

aliens. Most of these so-called witnesses were repeating the claims of others, and their testimony would be inadmissible hearsay in an American court. As for the several accounts from those who claimed to have seen aliens, critics identified a variety of problems with them. These problems ranged from the

08-13

reliability of second-hand accounts, to serious credibility problems with witnesses making demonstrably false or internally inconsistent claims, to dubious deathbed "confessions" or accounts from elderly or easily confused witnesses. A basic problem with all the witness accounts, according to the

08-14

critics, is that they all came a minimum of thirty-one years after the events in question, and in many cases were recounted more than forty years after the fact. Not only are memories this old of dubious reliability, they were also subject to contamination from other accounts the witnesses may have been exposed to.

08-15

Though there had always been skeptics who had many objections to the plausibility of these accounts, it was not until the mid-1990s that a strong counter-argument to the presence of aliens was widely publicized. The General Accounting Office launched an inquiry and directed the Office of the Secretary of the

07-13

worried look at Jill in the wings, who assured her with a positive thumbs up. Lucy thought to herself that she could not go through with this and that she, unlike her older sister, was not confident enough to put herself before the judging audience. The crowd looked up at her and Lucy was ready to run when the first notes of the music

07-14

sounded out, and a sudden calm settled over her. She closed her eyes and shut everything out, including the audience, the nerves that threatened to take over, the text messages, and the way they made her feel. It was just her and the music, and it was a love story that had been going on her whole life. She began to sing, and all

07-15

the pain and confusion that the messages had been causing inside her just flowed out. The words were not important, for it was the feeling behind them that she latched onto. Lucy was in the heart of the song with the rest of the world slipping away. When the song finished and the last note died away, she opened her eyes. To see the

07-16

whole audience on their feet and the hall filled with cheers and applause was not what Lucy had expected. Lucy allowed herself to enjoy the sense of achievement and belonging that she had not felt in a very long time. Then she saw her mother, who was cheering the loudest of all in the crowd, and Jill, who was beaming at her with pride from the wings.

07-17

She knew she owed them big time for reminding her what she was capable of and who she really was. The next time her phone bleeped she would tap the message straight into oblivion where it belonged.

08-01

The Roswell UFO Incident was the alleged recovery of extraterrestrial debris, including alien corpses, from an object that crashed near Roswell, New Mexico, on or about July 8, 1947. Since the late 1970s, the incident has been the subject of intense controversy and the subject of

08-02

conspiracy theories as to the true nature of the object that crashed. The United States military maintains the debris recovered was from an experimental high-altitude surveillance balloon that belonged to a classified program named "Mogul." However, many UFO proponents maintain that, in fact, a crashed alien

08-03

craft and bodies were recovered, and that the military then engaged in a cover-up. The incident has turned into a widely known pop culture phenomenon, making the name Roswell synonymous with UFOs. It ranks as one of the most publicized and controversial alleged UFO incidents.

08-04

On July 9, 1947, a press release that Roswell Army Air Field issued stated that personnel from the field's Bomb Group had recovered a crashed "flying disc" from a ranch near Roswell, sparking intense media interest. Later the same day, the Commanding General of the Eighth Air Force stated that,

08-05

in fact, a weather balloon had been recovered by the Roswell Army Air Field personnel, rather than a "flying saucer." A subsequent press conference was called, featuring debris from the crashed object that confirmed the weather balloon description. The case was quickly forgotten and almost completely ignored,